

earpiece, and thus needed a headset to be able to use the phone functionality. The next model, the BlackBerry 6210 (also called the BlackBerry Quark) was the first true phone, and added on BlackBerry Messenger (BBM). Thus the Quark was probably the first real “BlackBerry” in terms of being the type of device that we’ve come to expect from the company over the years.

Of course, all of these were still enterprise or professional targeted devices. The first consumer / end user oriented device was the Pearl 8100, which was launched in September 2006. Featuring a 65K colour screen (2.2-inch), 64 MB of memory, a 1.3 MP camera with LED flash, and weighing in at about 90 grams. The Pearl 8100 was also its first consumer success.

What really fuelled the adoption of devices was the fact that RIM tied up with many operators to provide their services globally. The fact that a BlackBerry was considered “professional” was good for it in India – as we’re a tribe who love to look serious and business-focused. What really pushed adoption was the best darn push mail service on the planet. Period. If you were really serious about email on the go, nothing beat a BlackBerry back then.

Between 2005 to 2008, email was the driving force of everything tech on the go – keeping in touch with buddies, getting updates in the form of mailers, everything work related was on email... Add in the fact that BBM was an exclusive group – IM-ing other BlackBerry users seemed posh – and you have the recipe for the roaring success that RIM tasted through those years. Yes the iPhone came in 2007, but it was expensive outside the US, and BlackBerry remained a solid player for many more years.



BlackBerry Quark



BlackBerry 8100